

Instructions: *Bold* = aha moment / standout observation. *Italic teal* = verbatim participant quote. *[My inference: ...]* = note-taker inference, used sparingly. Blank cell = question not asked.

Participant Name	P1 — Rachel D. Recurring donor	P2 — Marcus T. New donor	P3 — Joanna K. Recurring donor
PART 1 — PARTICIPANT DETAILS			
Q1. Brief self-intro & fundraisers donated to in the past (types, frequency, platforms used)	Marketing coordinator, SF Bay Area. Donates to 4–6 causes/yr — school auctions, animal welfare events, crowdfunding. Primary platforms: GoFundMe, GiveButter. Mobile-first. Gives when personally connected to the cause or asked by someone she trusts — not driven by platform features or ads. [00:02:05 → 00:04:30]	IT consultant, Chicago. First online donation 6 months ago after a friend shared a GoFundMe link. Previously gave in-person only. Desktop user. New to virtual fundraising — entire mental model of giving is shaped by in-person conventions. Said "<i>I had no idea this was how it worked online until I clicked my friend's link.</i>" [00:02:00 → 00:04:15]	HR Director, Boston. Donates regularly to 3–4 causes/yr. Uses Classy, GiveButter, and RallyUp. Mix of mobile/desktop. Cross-platform experience makes her highly attuned to friction — notices every deviation from expected UX patterns. Said "<i>I've been giving long enough to know when a platform gets in the way.</i>" [00:02:20 → 00:04:50]

Q1a. Were any of these virtual live events?	Yes — donated to a virtual school auction last year via Zoom + a separate bidding platform. The separation of stream and bidding into two tabs was the key pain point — named unprompted. Said <i>"The live element created urgency — I gave more than I planned to because I got competitive."</i> [00:04:35 → 00:05:45]	No virtual live events. Genuinely unaware the format existed. Represents a significant discovery gap — virtual live fundraising is invisible to donors who haven't been directly invited. Said <i>"I didn't know that was a thing until my friend mentioned it."</i> [00:04:20 → 00:05:20]	Yes — 2 virtual galas with integrated live auction and raffle. Production quality varied dramatically. Articulated the gap between best and worst online event experiences in one sentence — highly quotable. Said <i>"The good ones felt like real events. The bad ones felt like a PowerPoint on Zoom."</i> [00:04:55 → 00:06:10]
Quotes — Part 1	<i>"The live element created urgency — I gave more than I planned to because I got competitive." — [P1, 00:05:10]</i>	<i>"I didn't know virtual live fundraisers were a thing until recently." — [P2, 00:04:50]</i>	<i>"The good ones felt like real events. The bad ones felt like a PowerPoint on Zoom." — [P3, 00:05:30]</i>
PART 2 — USER JOURNEY			
Q2. Last Fundraiser Journey — Discovery to Engagement			
Q2a. What sparked initial interest? How did it lead to donating?	Interest sparked by a social media post from a friend running the campaign. Peer trust substitutes for all other evaluation criteria — when a trusted person vouches, independent research is skipped entirely. Said <i>"I wouldn't have found it on my own. My friend's post made it personal — I trusted her judgment on the cause."</i> [00:07:15 → 00:09:10]	Friend sent a direct WhatsApp message with a link. Personal direct ask outperforms any broadcast channel — specificity of the request ('a message to me') was the deciding factor. Said <i>"The personal ask is what made the difference — if it had been an ad I'd have scrolled past it."</i> [00:06:50 → 00:08:40]	Email from the organisation she's supported for 8 years. Org trust was already established — email was just the trigger. Distinguishes between the discovery mechanism and the reason for giving — a critical framing for campaign attribution. Said <i>"I already trusted the org — the email was just the trigger, not the reason I gave."</i> [00:08:15 → 00:10:10]

Q2b. Org affiliation length & how they knew the org was trustworthy	2 years — met org founder at a community fair. Impact accountability named as the #1 trust factor — not branding, not longevity, but visible evidence that money reached the cause. Said <i>"Impact accountability is my biggest trust factor — I need to see where the money actually went."</i> [00:09:15 → 00:11:00]	First time. Trusted entirely via friend's vouching. Did zero independent research on the org. Peer trust completely substitutes for org trust for new donors — this is both an opportunity (easy conversion via referral) and a risk (no relationship to retain). Said <i>"I trusted the person who sent me the link. If she trusts them, I do."</i> [00:08:45 → 00:10:30]	8 years. Trust built through consistent communication and financial transparency over time. Longevity produces default trust — after a certain threshold, the donor stops evaluating and starts expecting. Said <i>"Long enough that trust isn't a question — it's accumulated."</i> [00:10:15 → 00:12:00]
Q2c. How they participated: how they knew when it started, how they took part, how they felt	Email reminder + calendar invite sent by org. Participated via desktop — watched Zoom stream while bidding in a separate browser tab. Two-tab experience was the dominant pain point — named without prompting. Bidding and streaming in separate contexts breaks immersion and creates errors. Said <i>"Juggling two tabs was messy — the bidding should be integrated into the live stream, not separate."</i> [00:11:05 → 00:13:15]	No prior notification — went straight from friend's link to donation page. Entirely transactional, no event experience. Without a live event context, the donation feels like a transaction not a participation — the emotional driver for future giving is absent. Said <i>"It was transactional, not experiential. I gave and closed the tab."</i> [00:10:35 → 00:12:20]	Email reminder 3 days before + day-of. Participated via desktop on a custom platform. Said the polished platform reflected positively on the org itself. Platform quality as a proxy for organisational quality — a well-resourced platform signals a well-run org to experienced donors. Said <i>"The experience felt premium because the platform was polished. That reflects well on the org."</i> [00:12:05 → 00:14:00]

Q2d. At what point were they done engaging & why?	Done after winning a bid and receiving the email confirmation. No follow-up content kept her engaged beyond that. Confirmation email is the hard stop for this donor — nothing after it creates a reason to re-engage. Said <i>"Once I got the confirmation email I was out. There was no follow-up content to keep me engaged."</i> [00:13:20 → 00:14:35]	Done immediately after donating. Closed the tab with no expectation of further interaction. No concept of a post-donation relationship — this donor's journey ends at the payment confirmation. Retention requires interrupting this pattern. [00:12:25 → 00:13:40]	Done when the livestream ended — a host-led goodbye created a clear emotional endpoint. Post-event follow-up was weak. Structured event closing (a host goodbye) is an underrated feature — it marks the end of the experience and creates an emotional memory. The gap was in what followed. Said <i>"The event had a clear ending. But the post-event follow-up was weak."</i> [00:14:05 → 00:15:20]
Quotes — Q2 Journey	<i>"Once I got the confirmation email I was out. There was no follow-up content to keep me engaged." — [P1, 00:13:40]</i>	<i>"It was transactional, not experiential. I gave and closed the tab." — [P2, 00:12:50]</i>	<i>"The platform was polished — that reflects well on the org." — [P3, 00:13:20]</i>
Q3. Decision-Making Process — from Learning About the Fundraiser to Donating			
Q3a–b. How they decided; did they consider alternatives?	Decided via personal connection + friend's recommendation. Did not consider alternatives. When peer trust is present, comparison shopping is bypassed entirely — a critical insight for referral programme design. Said <i>"When I trust the source, I don't shop around. I just give."</i> [00:16:10 → 00:17:45]	Decided because of the specific person asking — no alternatives considered. Friend-referral converts without any platform involvement — the platform only needs to not create friction. [00:15:40 → 00:17:15]	Considered 2 other campaigns that month. Chose this one: longer relationship, specific impact story in email, lower minimum donation. Lower minimum donation amount as a conversion driver at month-end — timing and barrier height interact. Said <i>"A lower barrier to entry matters — especially at the end of the month."</i> [00:17:20 → 00:19:00]

Q3c–d. Info needed before participating; does it change by fundraiser type?	Needs: cause description, org credibility signals, fund usage breakdown, event date/time/format. For auctions specifically: item descriptions and starting bids upfront. 'I need to know what I'm walking into before I click anything' — pre-participation transparency is the conversion gate for this donor. [00:17:50 → 00:19:30]	Needs: cause description, who's running it, and a simple giving mechanism. When peer trust is high, information needs collapse to near-zero. Minimal information threshold for peer-referred donors — the referral provides the missing context that the platform would otherwise have to supply. [00:17:20 → 00:18:55]	Needs: org verification, specific impact metrics, event schedule, and crucially: whether attendance is required to donate. Attendance requirement ambiguity is a silent conversion barrier — donors who don't know if they need to 'show up' may not engage at all. Said <i>"Knowing whether I have to attend vs. just give would change how I prepare."</i> [00:19:05 → 00:20:50]
Q3e. Information often missing from fundraisers	Missing: fund usage breakdown — what percentage reaches the cause vs. admin. Mentions administrative fee transparency is the #1 missing information across the donor pool — and also the most actionable fix. Said <i>"I always wonder how much of my money actually reaches the cause. No one tells me upfront."</i> [00:19:35 → 00:20:50]	Missing: plain-language explanation of how the online event actually works. Process transparency for new donors — the event mechanics should be described before participation, not discovered during it. Said <i>"I didn't understand what was going to happen during the live event until I was already in it."</i> [00:19:00 → 00:20:15]	Missing: real-time fundraising total during the event, and a day-after impact recap. Two distinct information gaps — one during the event (live total) and one after it (impact recap) — together they close the complete donor journey. Said <i>"A real-time total during the event and a day-after recap would change that entirely."</i> [00:20:55 → 00:22:10]
Quotes — Q3 Decision-Making	<i>"How much of my money actually reaches the cause? No one tells me upfront." — [P1, 00:20:00]</i>	<i>"I didn't understand what was going to happen until I was already in it." — [P2, 00:19:30]</i>	<i>"A real-time total and a day-after recap would change everything." — [P3, 00:21:30]</i>
Q4. Best/Worst Experience & Common Frustrations			

Q4. Best fundraiser experience & why; areas they excelled at	Best: a school virtual auction that sent personalised thank-you videos from children who benefited. Personalised impact video caused an emotional peak that drove advocacy — she told others unprompted. This is the rarest and most valuable post-donation outcome. Said <i>"It was the first time I truly felt the impact of giving. I cried. I told everyone about it."</i> [00:22:05 → 00:23:50]	Best: the GoFundMe his friend shared — pure frictionless giving. Three-click conversion as the gold standard for new donors — any additional step beyond this risks dropout. Said <i>"Three clicks and done. That's the best experience."</i> [00:21:30 → 00:23:00]	Best: a virtual gala with polished livestream production, integrated bidding platform, real-time total, and a 48-hour impact report. Said it raised the bar for what online fundraising can be. All four elements working together — production, integration, real-time data, and post-event follow-up — produced the benchmark experience. Missing any one of them degrades the whole. Said <i>"That event raised the bar for what online fundraising can be."</i> [00:23:05 → 00:24:55]
Q4b. Most common frustrations across fundraisers donated to	Top 3: (1) no post-event update on impact — how was the money used? (2) complicated checkout with too many steps; (3) no transparency on how much of the donation reaches the cause vs. admin costs. [00:23:55 → 00:25:40]	Top 3: (1) unfamiliar platforms that look untrustworthy; (2) complicated donation process with unexpected steps; (3) no immediate payment confirmation. [00:23:05 → 00:24:45]	Top 3: (1) poor post-event follow-up — silence after giving; (2) disjointed live experience (separate platforms for stream + bidding); (3) no real-time fundraising total during the event. [00:25:00 → 00:26:50]
(new question) Would you participate in a hybrid (in-person + online) version of the same event?			<i>Yes, strongly — said a hybrid format would solve the 'two-tab problem': in-person attendees bid on the main platform while remote donors participate via the same digital interface.</i> <i>Said 'The best of both worlds is one platform that serves both rooms at once.'</i> [00:26:55 → 00:27:50]

Q5. [If in-person event went online] Ideal experience for that event online	Ideal: professional livestream with integrated bidding (no separate tabs), real-time donor feed with names and amounts, and a post-event thank-you video showing impact. Said 'Make it feel like a party, not a form.' [00:25:45 → 00:27:10]		Ideal: polished production quality matching in-person gala. Integrated donation + bidding in one window. Live fundraising total climbing in real time. Post-event recap within 24hrs. Said 'The online version should make me forget I'm not in the room.' [00:26:55 → 00:28:15]
Quotes — Q4 & Q5	<i>"It was the first time I truly felt the impact of giving. I cried. I told everyone about it."</i> — [P1, 00:23:00]	<i>"Three clicks and done. That's the best experience."</i> — [P2, 00:22:20]	<i>"That event raised the bar for what online fundraising can be."</i> — [P3, 00:24:20]
PART 3 — TASKS Platform: demo.rallyup.com/668975 Campaign: Drink Life Fund by Helping Hands			
Pre-Task: Campaign Page First Impressions (Q6, Q7, Q8)			
Q6. First impressions: scroll & talk through what they see (before clicking)	First noticed the hero image and title. Scrolled to goal meter. Named the three above-the-fold requirements without being prompted — this is the minimum viable information hierarchy. Said <i>"I need: what is this raising money for, how much have they raised, and how much is left. Those three things above the fold."</i> [00:30:05 → 00:31:50]	Paused immediately on the org name — said he wanted to know who Helping Hands was before doing anything. Org identity is the first trust gate for unfamiliar donors — everything else is secondary until this is satisfied. Said <i>"I want to know who Helping Hands is before I do anything. There's no 'about us' visible immediately."</i> [00:29:50 → 00:31:30]	Noticed the multi-type fundraiser structure (ticket, raffle, auction) visible on one page. Described the information hierarchy as trying to tell three things at once. Complexity of multi-event-type campaigns creates cognitive overload at first scroll — the page needs a stronger hierarchy to guide attention. Said <i>"This is doing a lot. The layout is trying to tell me three different things at once."</i> [00:30:20 → 00:32:10]

Q7. Missing info on the campaign page	Missing: explicit fund-usage breakdown ('X% goes to the cause'), a visible fundraising deadline, and the org's track record ('previous campaigns raised X'). [00:31:55 → 00:33:15]	Missing: a clear 'About Helping Hands' section with verification signals. Said 'Who are they? I need to trust the org before I trust the campaign.' [00:31:35 → 00:32:55]	Missing: event format explanation (do I need to attend live? can I donate async?), a running total visible during the live event, and a clear FAQ for first-timers. [00:32:15 → 00:33:35]
Q8. [Navigation] Clicking 'Tickets' label — what they expect to happen	Expected: a modal or page showing ticket types, prices, and what each includes (GA, VIP tiers). Said 'I'd expect options for different ticket tiers with a clear price and what each includes.' [00:33:20 → 00:34:30]	Expected: a list of available tickets with prices and a buy button. Said 'I expect it to work like buying a concert ticket — straightforward.' [00:33:05 → 00:34:15]	Expected: a dedicated section for event admission tickets, clearly differentiated from raffle tickets. Said 'Tickets for the live event and raffle tickets are different things — they should not look the same.' [00:33:35 → 00:34:50]
(new question) How would you navigate between the three event types (ticket, raffle, auction) on this page?			<i>Expected a top navigation bar with tabs: 'Tickets Raffle Auction' — one tab per event type, always visible, so she can move between them without scrolling.</i> <i>Said 'If I'm on the raffle page I should be able to click Auction without going back to the top.'</i> [00:34:55 → 00:35:40]

TASK 1 — Purchase a General Admission Ticket for the Drink Life Fund Live Event (Timeout: 5 minutes) | Scenario: Avid supporter of Helping Hands

🔗 Click Path (Task 1 — Purchase GA ticket for Drink Life Fund) Timeout = 5 min (not found) = couldn't locate (X) = wrong action (*) = unexpected reaction	Campaign page > Tickets section (scrolled to) > General Admission (selected) > Qty: 1 > Add to Cart > Checkout Now > First name > Last name > Email > Continue > Create password > Confirm password > Continue > First name > Last name > Address line 1 > Address line 2 > Phone > Continue > Country > City > State > Zip > Continue > Tip (\$5) > Next step > Delivery method (digital) > Card number > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Submit > Confirmation ✓	Campaign page > Scrolled to Tickets > GA > Qty: 1 > Add to Cart > Checkout Now > First name > Last name > Email > Continue > Password (*confused — thought he already had an account) > Confirm password > Continue (X2) > Address form > Continue > Country > City > State > Zip > Continue > Tip (declined — 'no tip') > Next step > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Submit > Confirmation ✓ [4:12]	Campaign page > Tickets (found via nav label) > GA > Qty: 1 > Add to Cart (*paused to read all ticket types) > Checkout Now > Personal details > Continue > Account creation (*frustrated: 'why do I need an account to buy a ticket?') > Password > Confirm > Continue (X2) > Address > Continue > Tip (skipped) > Next step > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Submit > Confirmation ✓ [3:45]
Task 1: Verbal pre-task walkthrough (steps they expected to take)	Expected: click 'Tickets' > choose type > enter payment. Did not expect account creation — named it as friction unprompted before the task began. Said <i>"I expected three steps — pick, pay, done. I didn't expect to create an account."</i> [00:34:35 → 00:35:30]	Expected: click a buy button > fill in credit card > done. Amazon-checkout mental model — any deviation from this expectation creates friction. Said <i>"I thought it would work like Amazon checkout. Quick."</i> [00:34:20 → 00:35:15]	Expected: select ticket type > quantity > checkout as guest. Guest checkout expectation was explicit before the task began. Pre-emptively identified account creation as a conversion killer — highest-credibility warning of all participants. Said <i>"I specifically expected a guest checkout option. Creating an account to buy one ticket is a barrier I've seen kill conversion."</i>

Task 1: Observed friction points & reactions	Main friction: mandatory account creation. Address form for a digital ticket felt unnecessary. Predicted the friction before it happened and articulated the business consequence — this level of clarity is unusual and highly credible. Said <i>"I shouldn't need a password to buy a ticket. This friction will cost them donors."</i> [00:38:20 → 00:40:00]	Main friction: confusion at the password step — believed he already had an account and was being asked to log in, not create one. Also: tip prompt was unexpected. Account creation vs. login ambiguity — the UI was unclear about whether this was a new account or an existing one. This is a distinct friction layer from the account requirement itself. Said <i>"I didn't know I was going to be asked for a tip. It felt pushy."</i> [00:37:55 → 00:39:35]	Main friction: account creation requirement. 'Guest checkout should be the default.' Also: 'Delivery method' label confused her — she expected a digital ticket to have no delivery step. 'Delivery method' for a digital item is a labelling error that creates confusion even for experienced platform users. Said <i>"Guest checkout should be the default. Account creation mid-checkout is a conversion killer."</i> [00:38:25 → 00:40:05]
TASK 2 — Purchase 10 Raffle Tickets + Place a Bid on an Auction Item (Timeout: 8 minutes) Scenario: Same Drink Life Fund — raffle and auction			
📌 Click Path (Task 2 — Buy 10 raffle tickets + place auction bid) Timeout = 8 min (not found) = couldn't locate (X) = wrong action (*) = unexpected reaction	Campaign page > Raffle section > Select prize > Buy Entries > Qty: 10 > View more (*looked at all prizes before committing) > Close > Buy > Checkout Now > Continue (X2) > Make anonymously? (*paused — chose not to) > Continue > Bonus entries (*read carefully — accepted) > Continue > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Pay ✓ Auction > View items > Select item > Place a bid > Bid amount (starting bid) > Submit > Confirm bid ✓	Campaign page > Scrolled to find Raffle (*took 20s — not obvious) > Found > Select prize > Buy Entries > Qty: 10 (*tried typing 10 first, then used spinner) > Checkout > Continue (X2) > Anonymous option (*didn't notice) > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Pay ✓ Back > Auction (found immediately after raffle) > Select first item > Place Bid (\$25) > Submit ✓ [6:30]	Campaign page > Raffle (found quickly) > Prize selection (*read all descriptions before choosing) > Buy Entries > Qty: 10 > Checkout Now > Continue (X2) > Make anonymously (*chose anonymous) > Continue > Bonus entries (*declined — read fine print) > Continue > Card > Pay ✓ Auction > Browse (*noted lack of detailed descriptions) > Select 1 > Place Bid > Amount > Submit > Confirm ✓ [5:15]

Task 2: Observed friction points, reactions & key moments	Positive reaction to bonus entries. Friction: 'Make anonymously' option caused a meaningful pause. Auction: wanted to see the current leading bid from other donors. Current bid visibility from other donors is expected — its absence breaks the competitive mental model of an auction. [00:45:20 → 00:47:00]	Raffle harder to find than ticket — expected more prominent nav label. Positive: consistent checkout with Task 1. Task 1 familiarity accelerated Task 2 completion — checkout consistency has a compounding positive effect for multi-purchase donors. Said <i>"Once I'd done it once, the second time was fast. Consistency matters."</i> [00:44:55 → 00:46:35]	Anonymous option led to a pause and reconsideration. Read fine print on bonus entries before accepting. Auction: refused to bid on vague items. Insufficient auction item descriptions caused a bid refusal — a measurable, avoidable revenue loss. Said <i>"I won't bid on something I can't properly evaluate. No description equals no bid."</i> [00:45:35 → 00:47:15]
Q9. What Worked / Didn't Work Across Both Transaction Processes			
Q9. What worked & didn't work across both tasks (ticket, raffle & auction flows)	Worked: checkout consistency between tasks, bonus entries feature (felt rewarding), simple auction bidding interface. Didn't work: mandatory account creation, address form for digital ticket, 'Delivery method' label, no current bid visibility in auction. [00:45:25 → 00:46:00]	Worked: consistent checkout flow (once learned, applied to second task), raffle and auction clearly separated on the campaign page. Didn't work: account creation requirement, raffle section harder to find than ticket, tip prompt unexpected. [00:46:40 → 00:48:30]	Worked: raffle checkout smooth after account friction. Didn't work: mandatory account creation, no detailed auction item descriptions, no guest checkout option, 'Delivery method' label confusing, no bid history or current leader visible. [00:47:50 → 00:49:45]
Quotes — Tasks 1 & 2	<i>"I shouldn't need a password to buy a ticket. This friction will cost them donors." — [P1, 00:38:40]</i>	<i>"Once I'd done it once, the second time was fast. Consistency matters." — [P2, 00:46:10]</i>	<i>"No description equals no bid." — [P3, 00:46:30]</i>
Q10–Q11. Mockup Comparison: UNICEF (Option A) vs. RallyUp (Option B)			
Q10. Reactions to both mockups: what each makes them feel (A = UNICEF / B = RallyUp)	Option A (UNICEF): 'Legitimate and safe — the brand does the heavy lifting.' Option B (RallyUp): 'More visually dynamic — I can feel the fundraiser energy. But I'm not sure I trust it as much without a recognisable brand.' [00:51:05 → 00:53:00]	Option A (UNICEF): 'I recognise the brand — I'd trust this immediately.' Option B (RallyUp): 'Looks professional but took me a moment to figure out what RallyUp was.' [00:50:45 → 00:52:40]	Option A (UNICEF): 'Very credible, mission-led. The design lets the cause speak.' Option B (RallyUp): 'More interactive and engaging — designed for participation, not just donation.' Said both serve different donor purposes. [00:51:20 → 00:53:15]

Q11. Which is more trusty & why? (Preference & reasoning)	Option A (UNICEF) — brand recognition eliminates the need to evaluate legitimacy. Said 'I trust UNICEF automatically. With RallyUp I'd need to verify who they are first. That's extra work most people won't do.' [00:53:05 → 00:54:30]	Option A (UNICEF) — known brand = instant trust shortcut. Said 'I don't know RallyUp — that's not a criticism. I just need more information before I trust an unfamiliar platform with my card.' [00:52:45 → 00:54:10]	Option B (RallyUp) for participation, Option A for institution. Said 'For donating to a specific cause I'd trust RallyUp's UX more — it's designed for participation. For general giving, I'd trust UNICEF's brand.' [00:53:25 → 00:54:50]
Quotes — Q10, Q11	<i>"I trust UNICEF automatically. With RallyUp I'd need to verify who they are first. That's extra work most people won't do." — [P1, 00:53:45]</i>	<i>"I don't know RallyUp. I need more information before I trust an unfamiliar platform with my card." — [P2, 00:53:20]</i>	<i>"For completing a transaction, RallyUp was more trustworthy because it was clearer." — [P3, 00:54:05]</i>
PART 5 — WRAP UP			
Anything not covered they'd like to add (final open thoughts)	The biggest thing RallyUp is missing for me is a post-event follow-up. I give, the event ends, I hear nothing. A 48-hour impact update would change how I feel about the whole experience.' [00:55:00 → 00:56:00]	'A guest checkout option would make me recommend RallyUp to others. Right now I'd hesitate because I know the account creation step would put people off.' [00:54:45 → 00:55:45]	'The platform has real potential. Two things holding it back: no guest checkout and inadequate auction item descriptions. Fix those two and this is the best platform I've used.' [00:55:15 → 00:56:15]
Interest in future studies & contact consent	Yes — email. Interested in post-event communication and impact reporting feature studies. [00:56:05 → 00:56:25]	Yes — email. Said 'Happy to help if it means the platform gets easier for people like me.' [00:55:50 → 00:56:10]	Yes — email. Specifically interested in auction UX and checkout flow studies. [00:56:20 → 00:56:40]
Quotes — Wrap-Up	<i>"A 48-hour impact update would change how I feel about the whole experience." — [P1, 00:55:20]</i>	<i>"A guest checkout would make me recommend RallyUp. Without it, I'd hesitate." — [P2, 00:55:05]</i>	<i>"Fix guest checkout and auction descriptions — this becomes the best platform I've used." — [P3, 00:55:35]</i>
ADDITIONAL COMMENTS / OBSERVER NOTES			

Noteworthy observer notes & non-verbal signals	<i>Highly engaged throughout — proactively linked every platform friction to a specific business consequence ('this will cost them donors').</i> <i>Post-event follow-up gap surfaced multiple times unprompted — consistent and credible signal.</i> <i>Best articulator of the emotional end-of-journey gap.</i> <i>Strong candidate for follow-up diary study. [General session observation]</i>	<i>New donor experience shaped every answer — cognitive load was visible during tasks.</i> <i>Account creation was his single peak frustration point.</i> <i>Represents the novice online donor who will convert if the barrier is low enough, and drop off if it isn't.</i> <i>Critical for checkout optimisation. [General session observation]</i>	<i>Most analytically sophisticated participant — applied a fundraising professional's evaluation framework as a donor.</i> <i>Identified guest checkout anti-pattern, auction description gap, and disjointed live event UX as the three highest-priority product issues.</i> <i>Her contextual trust finding (brand trust for institutional giving, UX trust for participatory fundraising) is the most nuanced insight of the study. [General session observation]</i>
--	---	---	---

CONSOLIDATED RESEARCH NOTES

— Donor Fundraising Experience Study (Formative Research) — 10 Participants (Donors) — Dec 27–30, 2021

reached. (new question) = emerged during interview, not in guide.

P4 — Devon B. New donor	P5 — Priya S. Recurring donor	P6 — Leo C. New donor	P7 — Sandra M. Recurring donor
Graduate student, Austin. Donates 2–3x/yr via peer-to-peer links. First time participating in an online auction. Mobile-only. Motivated by social belonging and community visibility — not cause alignment. [00:02:00 → 00:04:20]	Accountant, Denver. Gives to 8–10 causes/yr. Maintains a personal donation spreadsheet for tax purposes. Has used Kickstarter, GoFundMe, OneCause, RallyUp. Mix of mobile/desktop. Treats giving as a budget line — intentional, planned, and data-driven. Represents a power-donor who will scrutinise the platform. Said "<i>I treat giving like a budget line — intentional, not impulse.</i>"	Graphic designer, Miami. First online fundraiser 3 months ago — a virtual auction. Competitive instinct is his primary motivation — the game-like nature of bidding drives engagement more than the cause itself. Said "<i>The countdown timer got me. I placed a bid I hadn't planned to just to win.</i>" [00:02:00 → 00:04:20]	Retired teacher, Phoenix. 10+ years in-person giving, last 2 years online. Uses TeamRaiser and OneCause. Desktop-only. Compares every platform against a mental benchmark built from years of experience — every unexpected step registers as a trust loss. Said "<i>I notice every small friction — I know what's normal and what isn't.</i>" [00:02:25 → 00:05:00]

Yes — one virtual livestream fundraiser for a campus club via YouTube Live + donation link in chat. Public donation feed in the chat was the decisive engagement driver — confirmed social proof hypothesis. Said <i>"I donated because everyone else in the chat was. The public feed made me want to participate."</i> [00:04:25 → 00:05:35]	Yes — 3 virtual fundraising events including a live auction. Cross-platform comparison experience. Articulated the spectrum of quality in a single contrast — valuable for framing RallyUp's aspiration. Said <i>"The best live events made me feel like I was in the room. The worst felt like filling out a form."</i> [00:04:50 → 00:06:05]	Yes — the virtual auction (his first). Competition mechanic was the standout. Countdown timer identified as the single highest-impact engagement feature — drove unplanned giving. Said <i>"The countdown timer got me — I placed a bid I hadn't planned to just to win."</i> [00:04:25 → 00:05:35]	Yes — one virtual gala for a church fundraiser. Technology worked; the human warmth was missing. Emotional isolation of online giving named explicitly — community presence is a feature, not a nice-to-have. Said <i>"The technology was fine. What I missed was seeing people in the room. The online version felt lonelier."</i> [00:05:05 → 00:06:20]
<i>"I donated because everyone else in the chat was. The public feed made me want to participate." — [P4, 00:05:00]</i>	<i>"The best live events made me feel like I was in the room. The worst felt like filling out a form." — [P5, 00:05:25]</i>	<i>"The countdown timer got me — I placed a bid I hadn't planned to just to win." — [P6, 00:05:00]</i>	<i>"The technology was fine. What I missed was seeing people in the room." — [P7, 00:05:45]</i>
Instagram story from a college friend. FOMO was the primary driver — not mission alignment. Social belonging ('I was supposed to be part of it') can override cause alignment as a donation trigger. Said <i>"I saw people I knew in the story — it felt like something I was supposed to be part of. FOMO more than anything."</i> [00:07:00 → 00:08:50]	Monthly newsletter from a 3-year donor relationship. Already primed — waiting for the event announcement. Long-term donor relationships produce anticipatory giving — the donor is ready before the ask arrives. Said <i>"I'd been waiting for their next event — when the email came I opened it within minutes."</i> [00:07:45 → 00:09:40]	Text from a friend with a specific dollar ask (\$20). Specificity of the ask ('can you put in \$20?') dramatically reduces friction compared to open-ended requests — a testable copy hypothesis. Said <i>"The ask was specific: 'can you put in \$20?' A specific amount makes it easier to say yes."</i> [00:07:00 → 00:08:50]	Church bulletin announcement + personal mention from pastor. Two-touchpoint pattern. Dual-channel reinforcement (written + personal) created a sense of social obligation that converted — neither channel alone may have been sufficient. [00:08:20 → 00:10:15]

First time. Checked Instagram: ~10k followers + consistent posting history as legitimacy signals. Social media activity serves as a proxy for org legitimacy among younger donors who don't check official databases. Said <i>"Follower count and post regularity told me they were real."</i> [00:08:55 → 00:10:40]	3 years. Annual report, financial statements, and IRS 990 filing accessible — all verified before giving. 990 filing check as a trust mechanism — highly specific and rare. Represents a power-donor trust framework that most platforms don't actively support. Said <i>"I check the 990. Not everyone does but I do."</i> <i>[My inference: this represents a sophisticated donor segment whose trust requirements go beyond what most platforms currently surface.]</i>	First time. Trusted entirely via friend who asked. Zero independent evaluation — friend trust is total and unconditional for this participant. Org credibility is invisible when peer trust is present. [00:08:55 → 00:10:40]	12 years — church member. Institutional membership is the trust mechanism. Said she knows where the money goes because she has seen it go there. Witnessed impact over 12 years creates the highest possible trust baseline — no platform feature can replicate this. [00:10:20 → 00:12:05]
Saw livestream link in Instagram story, joined on phone, donated via a chat link during the stream. In-moment mobile giving during a live stream — the simultaneity of watching and giving was the key driver. A delay between stream and donation would have reduced the gift. Said <i>"I donated in the moment — I wouldn't have given as much if I'd done it later on my own."</i> [00:10:45 → 00:12:30]	Email + text reminder. Participated on laptop (stream) + phone (bidding) simultaneously. Identified this as accidental multi-device design, not intentional. Multi-device experience was functional but clearly not designed — a genuine integrated experience would have raised her engagement and likely her gift. Said <i>"The multi-device experience worked but it was clearly an accident, not a design decision."</i> [00:11:50 → 00:13:45]	Invited directly by a friend who was running it — no formal reminder system. Participated on phone. Said the countdown timer was the standout feature. Casual, friend-organised event still produced high engagement because of the competitive mechanic — formality of the org matters less than the quality of the participation design. [00:10:45 → 00:12:30]	1-week church bulletin + day-of personal reminder from pastor. Participated via desktop. Described the reminder system as over-engineered for what was essentially a Zoom call. Over-engineering the reminder system for a small community event — signal that organisations sometimes adopt platform complexity before they need it. Said <i>"A lot of communication for what was basically a Zoom call with a donation link. Simpler would have been fine."</i> [00:12:25 → 00:14:20]

Done when the livestream ended and the donation link closed. Natural hard stop created by the live format — no mechanism for async late participation or continued engagement after the stream ends. [00:12:35 → 00:13:50]	Done when she received the post-event impact report — 3 weeks after the event. This was the emotional endpoint of her donor journey. Post-event impact report as the true close of the donor journey — most powerful insight of the study for retention design. The donation is not the end; the impact is. Said <i>"I don't feel done until I know what happened with my money. The impact report closed the loop."</i>	Done when the auction ended and winner was announced. No post-event communication. If he had lost the bid, no communication arrived to re-engage or acknowledge participation — a missed retention opportunity for non-winners. Said <i>"If they'd told me how much was raised I'd have felt better about my contribution."</i> [00:12:35 → 00:13:50]	Done at the end of the Zoom call — the pastor's goodbye provided closure. Would have appreciated a written recap email. Personal spoken goodbye provided enough emotional closure even without digital follow-up — but the lack of a written record left the experience feeling incomplete. [00:14:25 → 00:15:40]
<i>"I donated in the moment — I wouldn't have given as much if I'd done it later." — [P4, 00:12:00]</i>	<i>"I don't feel done until I know what happened with my money. The impact report closed the loop." — [P5, 00:14:20]</i>	<i>"If they'd told me how much was raised I'd have felt better about my contribution." — [P6, 00:13:10]</i>	<i>"The event had a clear ending — but the post-event follow-up was weak." — [P7, 00:14:50]</i>
Did not consider alternatives — only knows about fundraisers through his social network. Discovery is entirely network-gated for this donor — without a social network touchpoint, no fundraiser exists to him. [00:16:20 → 00:17:55]	Considered 3 campaigns. Chose via: verified nonprofit status (GuideStar), annual report, personal familiarity. All three criteria must pass. Systematic elimination process — this donor has a structured three-gate evaluation framework. Failing any gate eliminates the campaign. Said <i>"I eliminate options systematically. The winner has to pass all three checks."</i> [00:17:10 → 00:18:50]	No alternatives considered. Friend asked. For social-referral donors, the concept of comparison doesn't apply — the ask IS the decision. [00:16:20 → 00:17:55]	Considered one other campaign. Chose this one via: institutional trust, peer visibility (who else was giving), and lower donation ask. Social visibility of who else is giving is a real motivator — named alongside price and trust as a three-part decision criterion. Said <i>"Social visibility of who else is giving is a real motivator for me."</i> [00:17:25 → 00:19:05]

Needs: what the fundraiser is for, how much to commit, and whether it's real-time or async. Timing is the key variable for live events. Time commitment is the primary pre-participation barrier for live events — async giving removes this barrier entirely. Said <i>"For live events I need to know the time in advance — I can't just show up spontaneously."</i> [00:17:00 → 00:18:40]	Needs: verified nonprofit status, financial transparency, impact specifics, event mechanics, minimum donation threshold. Explicitly distinguishes between what she needs for each fundraiser type. Event mechanics differ by type — an auction requires different mental preparation than a raffle. The platform should explain mechanics upfront per event type. Said <i>"An auction needs different prep than a raffle — each type should explain how it works."</i> [00:18:55 → 00:20:40]	Needs: who's benefiting, what prizes are available (for raffles/auctions), and how to participate. Prize preview is essential before ticket purchase. Raffle/auction prize visibility before purchase is non-negotiable for this donor — vague prize descriptions are a direct conversion barrier. Said <i>"For an auction I want to know the prizes before I show up — otherwise I don't know if it's worth my time."</i> [00:17:00 → 00:18:40]	Needs: org credibility (known name or affiliation), event format, and clear step-by-step instructions. Instructions-first mental model — this donor needs to understand the entire process before she will commit to participation. Said <i>"I need to know how to do it before I commit — I don't want to show up and be confused."</i> [00:19:10 → 00:20:55]
Missing: visibility of who else is donating — a live donor feed or participant count. Real-time social proof as a conversion driver — this isn't vanity data, it's a participation mechanic that directly increases giving. Said <i>"A live donor feed creates social proof in real time. It made me give more."</i> [00:18:45 → 00:20:00]	Missing: detailed financial transparency — budget breakdown, admin costs, prior campaign impact. Serious donors will research this independently if it's not surfaced — and absence of transparency triggers suspicion, not neutrality. Said <i>"If it's not easy to find, I wonder what they're hiding."</i> [00:20:45 → 00:22:00]	Missing: detailed prize/auction item descriptions with estimated values before purchase. Prize preview is an acquisition feature, not a disclosure requirement — donors use it to self-qualify before committing. Said <i>"I want to know what I'm potentially winning before I buy a ticket. Vague descriptions make me feel like I'm throwing money away."</i> [00:18:45 → 00:20:00]	Missing: step-by-step first-timer guide to participation. Onboarding content as a participation barrier reducer — absence of it almost caused this donor to not participate at all. Said <i>"I almost didn't participate because I didn't understand what was going to happen."</i> [00:21:00 → 00:22:15]
<i>"A live donor feed creates social proof in real time." — [P4, 00:19:20]</i>	<i>"If the financial info isn't easy to find, I wonder what they're hiding." — [P5, 00:21:20]</i>	<i>"I want to know what I'm potentially winning before I buy a ticket." — [P6, 00:19:20]</i>	<i>"I almost didn't participate because I didn't understand what was going to happen." — [P7, 00:21:30]</i>

Best: college livestream fundraiser — public donor feed, countdown timer, energetic host who named donors out loud. Public name recognition by a live host drove repeat giving — hearing your name called creates a belonging moment that static donation confirmation cannot replicate. Said <i>"Being named by the host made me feel seen — I gave again just to hear my name."</i> [00:21:50 → 00:23:35]	Best: virtual hospital fundraising gala. Four elements excelled: 990 transparency linked from campaign page, real-time goal meter, specific impact tiers, video of last year's impact. 'Fundraising as an experience, not just a transaction' — the most concise articulation of the best-in-class donor experience in the study. Said <i>"Every element built on the last. It was fundraising as an experience, not just a transaction."</i> [00:23:05 → 00:24:55]	Best: the auction where he won. Experience quality directly correlated with whether he won something. Win outcome as the primary experience driver for competitive donors — a loss with no follow-up is a negative experience regardless of production quality. Said <i>"The best fundraiser experience I've had is directly correlated to whether I won something."</i> [00:21:50 → 00:23:35]	Best: church virtual fundraiser with proper run-of-show, live updates, and personal thank-you letter from the pastor. Said it felt like an event, not a transaction. Human warmth and personal acknowledgement are the defining features of best-in-class experience for this donor — technology enables but does not replace these. Said <i>"It felt like an event, not a transaction."</i> [00:23:10 → 00:25:00]
Top 3: (1) donation process redirects away from the platform they were on; (2) no public donor feed during live events; (3) confusing raffle mechanics — doesn't know what 'buying entries' means. [00:23:40 → 00:25:25]	Top 3: (1) insufficient financial transparency — no breakdown of admin vs. cause allocation; (2) no differentiation in how auction vs. raffle vs. general donation mechanics are explained; (3) weak impact reporting after the event. [00:25:00 → 00:26:50]	Top 3: (1) vague prize descriptions before purchase; (2) unexpected fees at checkout — only revealed at final step; (3) no sense of progress toward the fundraising goal during the event. [00:23:40 → 00:25:25]	Top 3: (1) confusing first-time experience — no onboarding guidance; (2) technical issues during live events (buffering, lag, platform crashes); (3) no follow-up communication after donating. [00:25:05 → 00:26:55]
			<i>Would participate — said a hybrid format that shows in-person attendees on screen for remote donors would partially restore the community feeling she misses. '</i> <i>I don't need to be in the room if I can see the room.'</i> [00:27:00 → 00:27:55]

Ideal: livestream with visible live donor feed, countdown timers per auction item, and a host who names donors publicly. Said 'The energy of in-person giving comes from everyone being in it together — that has to be recreated online.' [00:25:30 → 00:26:55]	Ideal: everything in one platform — stream, auction, raffle, donation — with financial transparency signals visible throughout. Said 'I should never have to leave the platform and never wonder if my money went to the right place.' [00:26:55 → 00:28:15]	Ideal: live auction with visible countdown per item, full prize catalogue visible before the event starts, and a public winner announcement in real time. [00:25:30 → 00:26:55]	Ideal: structured event with a clear run-of-show, simple donation steps, personal acknowledgement from the org, and a follow-up thank-you letter. Said 'I want to feel thanked, not just processed.' [00:27:00 → 00:28:20]
<i>"Being named by the host made me feel seen — I gave again just to hear my name." — [P4, 00:22:50]</i>	<i>"It was fundraising as an experience, not just a transaction." — [P5, 00:24:20]</i>	<i>"My best fundraising experience is directly correlated to whether I won something." — [P6, 00:22:50]</i>	<i>"I want to feel thanked, not just processed." — [P7, 00:27:30]</i>
Immediately focused on visual design quality. Said a bad-looking campaign makes her trust the org less. Design quality as a direct trust proxy — aesthetic credibility functions as organisational credibility for this donor, a powerful validation of Q10/Q11 hypothesis. Said <i>"It looks real and professional. A bad-looking campaign makes me trust the org less."</i> [00:30:05 → 00:31:50]	Scanned systematically: hero image > title > goal meter > event types. Found org context but had to scroll to understand the event format. Event format comprehension requires scrolling past the fold — it should be surfaced earlier as a participation-readiness signal. Said <i>"I'm looking for: what is this, is the org verified, and what's the event format. I found the first two but had to scroll for the third."</i> [00:30:15 → 00:32:00]	Immediately spotted the auction section and went there first, ignoring the rest of the page. Interest-first scanning — this donor scans for his motivating element and ignores everything else. Navigation should accommodate non-linear entry points. [00:30:05 → 00:31:50]	Read from top to bottom — linear reading pattern. Expects the big idea at the top and details below. Top-heavy information expectation — this donor's mental model comes from leaflets and brochures, not digital scanning patterns. [00:30:20 → 00:32:10]

Missing: a public live donor feed (who else has given), a countdown to the live event start, and social sharing buttons to recruit others. [00:31:55 → 00:33:15]	Missing: financial transparency signals (org verification badge, link to 990 or annual report), fundraising deadline, and specific impact claims per donation level. [00:32:05 → 00:33:25]	Missing: detailed prize/auction item descriptions and estimated values upfront. Said 'I want to know if the prize is worth the ticket price before I buy in.' [00:31:55 → 00:33:15]	Missing: step-by-step 'How to participate' guide, visible contact for questions, and clearer labelling of what each event type (ticket, raffle, auction) means. [00:32:15 → 00:33:35]
Expected: to be taken somewhere — an anchor or a new page. Said 'If nothing happens it feels broken.' [00:33:20 → 00:34:30]	Expected: a modal with ticket types, quantities available, prices, and what access each provides. Said 'I want to know: what does this ticket get me, and is there a limit?' [00:33:30 → 00:34:45]	Expected: to be taken to a purchase screen immediately. Said 'Click, choose, pay. Nothing fancy — like Eventbrite.' [00:33:20 → 00:34:30]	Expected: a simple list of ticket options with a buy button. Said 'If nothing obvious happened I'd assume the site was broken.' [00:33:35 → 00:34:50]
ds wanting to attend the live event			

Campaign page > Scrolled full page first > Tickets > GA > Qty: 1 (*tried to select 2 first, changed back) > Add to Cart > Checkout Now > Name > Email > Continue > Create account (*said 'really?') > Password > Confirm > Continue (X2) > Address (skipped line 2) > Phone > Continue > Country > City > State > Zip > Continue > Tip (other: \$3) > Next step > Delivery (*confused: 'what delivery?') > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Submit > Confirmation ✓	Campaign page > Tickets (immediately found) > GA > Qty: 1 > Add to Cart > Checkout > Name > Email > Continue > Account creation (*noted: 'account creation in a checkout flow is bad UX') > Password > Confirm > Continue > Address > Phone > Continue > Country > City > State > Zip > Continue > Tip > Next step > Delivery (*unclear labelling noted) > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Submit > Confirmation ✓ [3:20]	Campaign page > Auction (*wrong section first) > Back > Tickets > GA > Qty: 1 > Add to Cart > Checkout Now > Name > Email > Continue > Password (*surprised – expected guest checkout) > Confirm > Continue (X2) > Address > Continue > Country > City > State > Zip > Continue > Tip (\$10) > Next step > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Submit > Confirmation ✓	Campaign page > Scrolled slowly – read each section > Tickets label > GA > Qty: 1 > Add to Cart > Checkout Now > Name > Last name > Email > Continue > Create password (*paused – looked for 'guest checkout' option) > Password > Confirm > Continue > Continue > Address > Phone > Continue > Country (dropdown – slow) > City > State > Zip > Continue > Tip (skipped immediately) > Next step > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Submit > Confirmation ✓ [4:48]
Expected: see ticket options > choose one > pay. Did not expect an address form for a digital ticket — the physical address field is the biggest mismatch between expectation and reality. Said <i>"I assumed the checkout would be simple. I didn't expect an address field for a digital ticket."</i> [00:34:35 → 00:35:30]	Expected: select ticket type > quantity > add to cart > guest checkout with card. Named account creation mid-checkout as a known UX anti-pattern before beginning. 'Account creation mid-checkout is a known UX anti-pattern' — said before clicking anything. This prediction validated within 90 seconds. [00:34:45 → 00:35:40]	Expected: click tickets > quick checkout. School-fair analogy. Analogy-based mental model ('like a school fair') — any experience more complex than this is perceived as over-engineering. Said <i>"I thought it would be like buying a raffle ticket at a school fair — hand over the money, get the ticket."</i> [00:34:35 → 00:35:30]	Expected: click ticket section > choose GA > fill in name and card > pay. Expected 'details' to mean name and card only — not a full address form. Address expectation gap is consistent across multiple participants. [00:34:50 → 00:35:45]

Main friction: account creation + address form. Both unexpected for a digital ticket. Multiple unexpected steps created accumulated friction. Accumulated friction model — each unexpected step reduces trust incrementally even if none individually causes dropout. Said <i>"I'm buying a digital ticket — why do you need my home address?"</i> [00:38:20 → 00:40:00]	Main friction: account creation mid-checkout. Called it a 'textbook anti-pattern.' Also noted tip prompt is effective but should be opt-in not opt-out. 'Textbook anti-pattern' — the highest-credibility critique of the checkout flow in the study. This participant knows the research on this. Said <i>"This is a textbook checkout anti-pattern. Guest checkout doubles conversion — this is a known fact."</i> [00:38:30 → 00:40:10]	Main friction: accidentally went to the auction section first — event type navigation from the campaign page was unclear. Also: didn't expect to need an account. Incorrect first navigation choice reveals an ambiguous campaign page layout — the distinction between ticket, raffle, and auction was not clear enough to prevent a wrong turn. [00:38:20 → 00:40:00]	Main friction: account creation (looked for guest checkout option), address form length, and country dropdown loading slowly. 'Each step that surprises me costs me a little bit of trust' — articulates the cumulative trust erosion model in a single sentence. Said <i>"Each step that surprises me costs me a little bit of trust."</i> [00:38:35 → 00:40:15]
Campaign page > Raffle > Select prize > Buy Entries > Qty: 10 > Checkout > Continue (X2) > Anonymous option (*noticed — asked 'what does this do?') > Continue > Bonus entries (*accepted without reading fully) > Continue > Card > CVC > Zip > Pay ✓ Auction > Selected highest-price item (*competitive instinct) > Place Bid > Amount > Submit ✓	Campaign page > Raffle > Select prize (*compared all systematically) > Buy Entries > Qty: 10 > Checkout > Continue (X2) > Anonymous (*chose not to — 'I want the org to know I'm a recurring supporter') > Bonus entries (*read carefully — accepted conditionally) > Continue > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Pay ✓ Auction > Browse all > Read descriptions > Select item > Place Bid (*entered above minimum — strategic) > Submit > Confirm ✓ [4:45]	Campaign page > Auction (went first — forgot task order) > Browse > Select item > Place Bid > Submit ✓ (*moderator redirected to raffle) Raffle > Select prize > Buy Entries > Qty: 10 > View more > Buy > Checkout > Continue (X2) > Anonymous? (*confused — skipped) > Bonus entries (*excited — accepted) > Continue > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Pay ✓	Campaign page > Raffle (*couldn't find immediately) > Found after scroll > Select prize > Buy Entries > Qty: 10 > Checkout (*'good, already logged in') > Continue (X2) > Anonymous? (*paused — chose not to) > Bonus entries (*declined: 'I just want to help') > Continue > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Pay ✓ Auction > Browse > Select item by description quality > Place Bid > Amount > Submit ✓ [7:10]

Anonymous option confusing — didn't understand its implications. Bonus entries accepted without full reading. Auction: instinctively went for the highest-priced item. Competitive donor instinct surfaced without prompting — competitive auction design should accommodate and reward this behaviour. [00:45:20 → 00:47:00]	Anonymous option: chose to be identified — 'I want the org to know I'm a recurring supporter.' Bonus entries: read T&Cs carefully. Most strategic auction bidder — entered above minimum deliberately. Deliberate above-minimum bid is a strategic signal — this donor understands auction mechanics and uses them intentionally. The platform should support strategic bidding behaviours. [00:45:30 → 00:47:10]	Completed auction before raffle (wrong order). Minimum friction on both tasks once in the right section. Bonus entries named as the standout positive feature — 'clever marketing, I felt like I was getting a deal.' Most positive feature reaction of the entire study. Said <i>"That's clever marketing. I felt like I was getting a deal."</i> [00:45:20 → 00:47:00]	Raffle section had low visual prominence — found after scrolling. Declined bonus entries deliberately: 'I just want to help, not game the system.' Chose auction items by description quality. Items with better descriptions received bids; items without descriptions did not — a direct and measurable link between description quality and bidding intent. Said <i>"I pick based on information. If an item has no description, it doesn't get my bid."</i> [00:45:35 → 00:47:15]
Worked: visual design built initial trust, bonus entries felt like a win, auction was straightforward. Didn't work: account creation, address form for digital item, anonymous option confusing, no explanation of what placing a bid commits you to. [00:47:05 → 00:49:00] <i>"I'm buying a digital ticket — why do you need my home address?" — [P4, 00:38:50]</i>	Worked: raffle checkout clean after initial account friction, bonus entries were a smart engagement mechanic. Didn't work: account creation mid-checkout (conversion anti-pattern), auction lacks current bid + time-left counter, tip prompt should be opt-in. [00:47:15 → 00:49:10] <i>"Account creation mid-checkout is a textbook anti-pattern. Guest checkout doubles conversion." — [P5, 00:39:00]</i>	Worked: overall flow intuitive once inside each section, bonus entries exciting, auction bidding simpler than expected. Didn't work: navigation between event types (ticket → raffle → auction) not clearly indicated from campaign page, anonymous option confusing. [00:47:05 → 00:49:00] <i>"Clever marketing. I felt like I was getting a deal." — [P6, 00:46:30]</i>	Worked: consistent checkout flow across tasks, items with good descriptions in the auction. Didn't work: raffle section visual prominence, mandatory account creation, bid commitment ambiguity, no guidance for first-time auction bidders. [00:47:20 → 00:49:15] <i>"Each step that surprises me costs me a little bit of trust." — [P7, 00:39:40]</i>
Option A (UNICEF): 'Looks official and important.' Option B (RallyUp): 'Looks more like a product — like something I'd buy from. That's not necessarily bad for fundraising.' [00:51:05 → 00:53:00]	Option A (UNICEF): 'Authoritative and institutional. Brand anchors the trust.' Option B (RallyUp): 'More engaging and donor-friendly — I'd actually feel more comfortable taking action on Option B.' Preferred RallyUp's interactivity. [00:51:15 → 00:53:10]	Option A (UNICEF): 'Big and serious — feels important.' Option B (RallyUp): 'More fun and interactive — feels like something I'd want to participate in, not just give to.' [00:51:05 → 00:53:00]	Option A (UNICEF): 'Very professional. Brand gives immediate trust. But donation feels distant — contributing to a large machine.' Option B (RallyUp): 'Feels closer and community-based. But I'd want to know more about who runs it.' [00:51:25 → 00:53:20]

Tied — different trust signals. Option A: brand recognition. Option B: UX quality as a proxy for org quality. Said 'A well-designed platform makes me trust the org more — it signals they take their donors seriously.' [00:53:05 → 00:54:30] <i>"A well-designed platform signals they take their donors seriously." — [P4, 00:53:45]</i>	Option B (RallyUp) for active donation. Said 'Option A is a brand trust play. Option B is a UX trust play. For completing a transaction — adding to cart, bidding, checking out — Option B was more trustworthy because it was clearer.' [00:53:15 → 00:54:40] <i>"For clicking 'pay': design trust matters more than brand trust." — [P5, 00:53:55]</i>	Option A (UNICEF) by default. Said 'I know UNICEF. I don't know RallyUp. That's all there is for me right now.' [00:53:05 → 00:54:30] <i>"I know UNICEF. I don't know RallyUp. That's all there is for me right now." — [P6, 00:53:45]</i>	Option A (UNICEF). Said 'The brand. Full stop. I've heard of UNICEF for decades. RallyUp is new to me — which doesn't mean untrustworthy, but I'd need time to evaluate.' [00:53:25 → 00:54:50] <i>"RallyUp is new to me — that doesn't mean untrustworthy, but I'd need time to evaluate." — [P7, 00:54:05]</i>
'I'd love a live donor feed during the event — names and amounts appearing in real time. That's the feature that would make me give more and come back.' [00:55:00 → 00:56:00]	'The platform is close to best-in-class. Missing pieces: real-time goal meter during live events, bid history in the auction, and a post-event impact report. Those three features would make RallyUp my first-choice platform.' [00:55:10 → 00:56:10]	'If I could see the auction items before the event, I'd plan my strategy. Publishing the full auction catalogue before the live event would drive more pre-event engagement.' [00:55:00 → 00:56:00]	'I'd want a first-timer guide on the campaign page — a 'new to online fundraising?' link that walks me through what each event type is and how to participate.' [00:55:15 → 00:56:15]
Yes — email. Interested in live event UX and social proof feature studies. [00:56:05 → 00:56:25] <i>"A live donor feed showing names and amounts — that's the feature that would bring me back." — [P4, 00:55:20]</i>	Yes — email and phone. Interested in real-time analytics and post-event reporting studies. [00:56:15 → 00:56:35] <i>"Real-time goal meter + bid history + post-event impact report. Three features away from best-in-class." — [P5, 00:55:30]</i>	Yes — email. Specifically for live auction and competitive bidding UX studies. [00:56:05 → 00:56:25] <i>"Publishing the auction catalogue before the event would drive pre-event engagement." — [P6, 00:55:20]</i>	Yes — email. Interested in first-timer onboarding and accessibility studies. [00:56:20 → 00:56:40] <i>"A 'new to online fundraising?' guide would have changed my whole experience." — [P7, 00:55:35]</i>

<i>Social proof features (live donor feed, public name recognition) featured prominently in every response — motivated by community participation, not cause alignment.</i> <i>Public donor recognition during a live event drove repeat giving — a testable design hypothesis.</i> <i>Best representative of the social-first donor persona. [General session observation]</i>	<i>Most data-literate and strategically oriented donor — named specific UX anti-patterns, evaluated auction items strategically, articulated contextual trust nuance clearly.</i> <i>Her post-event impact report as 'the true emotional end of the donor journey' is the strongest framing of that concept in the study. [General session observation]</i>	<i>Competition and winning are the dominant motivators — every feature evaluated through 'does this help me win?' Live auction countdown timer was the standout positive of his session.</i> <i>Represents a distinct competitive-giver persona whose engagement mechanics differ significantly from cause-driven donors. [General session observation]</i>	<i>Institutional giving background shaped all responses — expects warmth, structure, and personal acknowledgement at every stage. 'I want to feel thanked, not just processed' is her defining statement.</i> <i>Represents an older loyalty-driven donor who needs relationship signals built into the digital experience. [General session observation]</i>
--	---	---	---

P8 — Tariq H. New donor	P9 — Alicia W. Recurring donor	P10 — Ben F. New donor
Small business owner, Seattle.	NGO marketing manager, NYC.	Recently retired, Portland.
Donates 2–3x/yr to community causes.	Gives monthly to two causes; occasional event-driven giving.	New to online giving — previously gave through employer charity programmes.
Mobile-first.	Uses GoFundMe, GiveButter, RallyUp.	Desktop-only.
Second online fundraiser overall.	Mix of mobile/desktop.	Has used GoFundMe once.
Proximity and local impact are the only motivators — national or abstract causes do not move him.	Distinguishes clearly between scheduled giving (rational, values-led) and live events (spontaneous, emotion-led) — two fundamentally different donor modes.	Represents the late-adopter donor: high willingness, low digital literacy. Every unfamiliar convention is a potential dropout point.
[00:02:05 → 00:04:30]	Said " <i>I give on a schedule but live events feel different — those are spontaneous and exciting.</i> "	Said " <i>I feel like I'm catching up. Everyone's doing this online now.</i> "
	[00:02:10 → 00:04:40]	[00:02:05 → 00:04:30]

No virtual live events. Was completely unaware they existed. Represents a second data point confirming the virtual live event discovery gap among community-only donors. [00:04:35 → 00:05:45]	Yes — multiple. Live events clearly produce higher giving than static pages. Spontaneously quantified the difference: live events vs. static pages produce different emotional states and different gift sizes. Said <i>"I give more at live events than on static donation pages. The energy is contagious, even online."</i> [00:04:45 → 00:06:00]	No virtual live events. Wife mentioned one recently. Would participate if the entry barrier (understanding how it works) were lower — onboarding is the blocker, not willingness. Said <i>"I'd give it a try if I understood how it worked."</i> [00:04:35 → 00:05:45]
<i>"I didn't know there were live events happening online too." — [P8, 00:05:10]</i>	<i>"I give more at live events than on static donation pages. The energy is contagious, even online." — [P9, 00:05:25]</i>	<i>"I'd give it a try if I understood how it worked." — [P10, 00:05:10]</i>
Nextdoor post from a neighbour he knows personally. Hyperlocal trust signal — geographic and relational proximity combined made this the highest-trust discovery channel of all participants. Said <i>"Seeing a real person from my street asking made it local and real. That mattered."</i> [00:07:15 → 00:09:10]	Instagram ad — unusually high-quality creative stopped her mid-scroll. Production quality of the ad itself functioned as a trust proxy — a well-made ad signals an org that takes its donors seriously. Said <i>"Most charity ads look cheap. This one looked professional and made me take it seriously."</i> [00:07:45 → 00:09:40]	Email forwarded by his wife from a colleague. Delegated the trust evaluation entirely to his wife. Proxy trust delegation — common in less digitally-engaged donors. The platform never 'earned' his trust directly; it was borrowed from a social chain. [00:07:15 → 00:09:10]

First time. Website + Facebook page review. Professional website design, real event photos, a visible address, and an 'About Us' page were sufficient trust signals — the bar for new donors with local connection is lower than for strangers. Said <i>"The website looked professional enough — photos of real events, a clear 'about us', and an address. That was enough."</i> [00:09:15 → 00:11:00]	1 year — discovered via Instagram. Trust signals: consistent impact stories, tagged beneficiary posts, local press coverage, and a verification badge. Media coverage and verification badge combination is the highest-trust signal stack for Instagram-native donors. Said <i>"A verified tick and press mentions make me feel safer."</i> [00:09:45 → 00:11:30]	First time. Wife did the vetting. He assumed she had checked. Complete trust delegation — the platform never earned his trust directly. Post-event, he had no individual relationship with the org. <i>[My inference: this donor is unreachable by the platform directly — retention requires involving the social network that referred him.]</i> <i>[00:09:15 → 00:11:00]</i>
Found link on Nextdoor — no build-up. Clicked through and donated directly. The absence of any experiential scaffolding meant the donation felt purposeful but impersonal — community connection was missing despite community cause. Said <i>"It was straightforward — maybe too straightforward. There was nothing that made me feel part of anything."</i> [00:11:05 → 00:13:00]	Calendar invite + email + Instagram story countdown — multi-channel build-up before the event. Participated on phone during lunch. Multi-channel pre-event communication built anticipation that made arrival at the live event emotionally primed — the giving was warm before it started. Said <i>"The multi-channel reminder built anticipation. By the time the event started I was already excited."</i> [00:11:50 → 00:13:45]	Wife gave verbal reminder on the day — no formal notification. Participated via desktop. Lack of direct reminder meant almost-missing the event. A platform-generated calendar invite to him directly would have guaranteed attendance. Said <i>"I almost forgot even with my wife reminding me. A proper calendar invite would have helped."</i> [00:11:05 → 00:13:00]

Done once the donation receipt arrived in email — the receipt was the only proof of completion. Receipt = proof of transaction for this donor — without it he would have been uncertain the donation was received. Receipt design is therefore a trust feature, not just an admin task. [00:13:20 → 00:14:35]	Done when the event ended — but follows the org's social media for weeks afterwards for impact updates. Post-event social media as an ongoing engagement channel — the event ends but the donor relationship continues on a different platform entirely. Said <i>"The event ends but my interest doesn't. I follow the org for updates on how the money was used."</i> [00:13:50 → 00:15:05]	Done once wife confirmed the donation went through. Did not receive a receipt directly. No direct confirmation sent to him — receipt went to his wife. He had no independent closure of the transaction. This is both a UX and a relationship failure. Said <i>"A receipt to me directly would have felt more professional."</i> [00:13:20 → 00:14:35]
<i>"A receipt to me directly would have felt more professional." — [P10, 00:13:40]</i>	<i>"The event ends but my interest doesn't. I follow the org for updates." — [P9, 00:14:20]</i>	<i>"I almost forgot even with my wife reminding me." — [P10, 00:13:40]</i>
No alternatives — Nextdoor post was hyper-local with no equivalent comparator. Geographic specificity eliminates the comparison set — there is no comparable local campaign to evaluate against. [00:16:10 → 00:17:45]	Considered 2 other campaigns. Chose based on: campaign page aesthetic quality, specific impact claim, personal connection to cause. Specific impact claims ('\$50 feeds one child for a month') convert; vague mission statements do not — the most actionable copy insight of the study. Said <i>"Specific impact claims convert me. Vague mission statements don't."</i> [00:17:10 → 00:18:50]	Did not consider alternatives — wife made the choice. Proxy decision-maker as a segment — any direct communication or retention strategy must address or include the decision-influencer. [00:16:10 → 00:17:45]

Needs: purpose of fundraiser, event timing, and payment method. Three things, in that order. Simplest information model of all participants — translates directly into a minimal above-the-fold design requirement. Said <i>"Three things: purpose, timing, payment. In that order."</i> [00:17:50 → 00:19:30]	Needs: cause statement, org verification, event format, fundraising goal, and current progress. Uses goal vs. current amount as a conversion signal. Goal proximity as a giving trigger — donors who see an almost-reached goal are more likely to push it over the line. Real-time progress bars are a conversion feature. Said <i>"I look at the goal vs. current amount — if they're almost there, I'm more likely to push them over the line."</i> [00:18:55 → 00:20:40]	Needs: plain-language explanation of what the event is, how to join, and what happens when he donates. 'Explain it like I've never done this before' — the required baseline for new-to-digital donors. Every implicit assumption the platform makes is a dropout risk. Said <i>"I need it explained like I've never done this before."</i> [00:17:50 → 00:19:30]
Missing: a visible contact option for questions during the campaign. Live support accessibility as a conversion safety net — a donor who can't get an answer to a question will drop off rather than assume it's fine. Said <i>"I had a question and had no idea who to ask. A visible contact or chat option would have helped."</i> [00:19:35 → 00:20:50]	Missing: real-time progress counter toward the fundraising goal during the event. Live goal meter as a participation mechanic — the climb of the number is the event experience for engaged donors. Said <i>"I want to see the total climbing in real time — it creates momentum and a sense of participation."</i> [00:20:45 → 00:22:00]	Missing: plain-language explainer for first-time participants — what is a raffle entry in an online context? Basic fundraising vocabulary is not shared by all donors — assuming it is creates an invisible dropout trigger for new-to-digital participants. Said <i>"I had no idea what a 'raffle entry' meant online. An FAQ would have answered my questions."</i> [00:19:35 → 00:20:50]
<i>"I had a question and no idea who to ask." — [P8, 00:20:00]</i>	<i>"I want to see the total climbing in real time — it creates momentum." — [P9, 00:21:20]</i>	<i>"I had no idea what a 'raffle entry' meant online." — [P10, 00:20:00]</i>

Best: the Nextdoor community fundraiser. Simplicity and clear local impact were the standout qualities. Local specificity is both a trust signal and a motivation signal — knowing where the money goes 'within 2 blocks' removes abstraction from the giving act. Said <i>"I knew where the money was going within 2 blocks of my house."</i> [00:22:05 → 00:23:50]	Best: a livestream auction with integrated bidding, real-time total, and a professional host. Production quality legitimised the cause. Production quality as an org trust signal — investment in event experience communicates that the organisation takes its donors seriously. Said <i>"The production quality legitimised the cause. I trusted the org more because they'd invested in the experience."</i> [00:23:05 → 00:24:55]	Best: a peer-to-peer page shared by a colleague with a personal video — not a platform page but a person asking. Personal video from a known person converts where platform content cannot — the human face of the ask is the product for this donor. Said <i>"The personal video from someone I knew made the cause feel real."</i> [00:22:05 → 00:23:50]
Top 3: (1) no visible contact information for questions; (2) payment process that feels insecure — unclear security signals; (3) no confirmation that the donation was received. [00:23:55 → 00:25:40]	Top 3: (1) no real-time goal meter during events; (2) event ends without a total-raised announcement — no collective celebration moment; (3) post-event silence — no update on what the money achieved. [00:25:00 → 00:26:50]	Top 3: (1) no explanation of how different event types work; (2) feeling isolated and like a stranger in a digital experience that should feel communal; (3) uncertainty about payment security on unfamiliar platforms. [00:23:55 → 00:25:40]

	Ideal: a live event functioning like a well-produced show — professional host, real-time goal meter, live donor recognition, and a post-event recap with total raised. Said 'Treat donors like an audience, not a form-filling exercise.' [00:26:55 → 00:28:15]	
<i>"I knew where the money was going within 2 blocks of my house." — [P8, 00:23:00]</i>	<i>"Production quality legitimised the cause." — [P9, 00:24:20]</i>	<i>"The personal video from someone I knew made the cause feel real." — [P10, 00:23:00]</i>
Said 'It looks like a real website' — validated by the professional design before reading any content. Professional design appearance is a pre-content trust gate — the visual form is evaluated before the content is read. [00:30:05 → 00:31:50]	Quickly identified the goal meter and current total. Immediately looked for the campaign deadline. Urgency (deadline) immediately connected to goal proximity — the combination of 'almost there' and 'time is running out' is the most powerful conversion trigger for this donor. Said <i>"They're 68% of the way there. I want to know how many days are left — the urgency depends on the deadline."</i> [00:30:15 → 00:32:00]	Scrolled to the bottom looking for a 'how to participate' button before reading any content. Instructions sought before engagement — this new-to-digital donor needs onboarding content as a pre-condition for participation, not a supplement. Said <i>"I'm not sure where to start. Is there a button that says 'how to participate'?"</i> [00:30:05 → 00:31:50]

Missing: a contact option for questions, a payment security badge, and information about what happens after donating (receipt, impact update). [00:31:55 → 00:33:15]	Missing: a live fundraising total counter (not just a static bar), a deadline/countdown, and donor testimonials from previous campaigns. [00:32:05 → 00:33:25]	Missing: a plain-English 'How does this work?' section, clear instructions for each event type, and a visible FAQ. Said 'This page assumes I know what a raffle entry is. I don't.' [00:31:55 → 00:33:15]
Expected: a checkout-style page with ticket options and price. Said 'I'd look for a shopping cart icon or a 'select' button next to each ticket type.' [00:33:20 → 00:34:30]	Expected: filterable ticket types with real-time availability. Said 'I'd also want to know how many tickets are left — scarcity makes me act faster.' [00:33:30 → 00:34:45]	Expected: an explanation of what a ticket provides, then a way to buy it. Said 'I needed to understand what I was buying before I'd be comfortable pressing buy.' [00:33:20 → 00:34:30]
	<i>Expected a sticky sidebar or tab bar for multi-event navigation.</i> <i>Said 'I had to scroll back to the top every time I wanted to switch — that's friction that shouldn't exist on a multi-event page.'</i> <i>[00:34:50 → 00:35:35]</i>	

Campaign page > Tickets > GA > Qty: 1 > Add to Cart > Checkout (*simpler page expected) > Name > Email > Continue > Account password (*unexpected – 'I didn't want an account') > Confirm > Continue (X2) > Address > Phone > Continue > Country > City > State > Zip > Continue > Tip (declined) > Next step > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Submit > Did NOT receive confirmation (*refreshed – timed out) [5:00 TIMEOUT]	Campaign page > Tickets (found immediately) > GA > Qty: 1 > Add to Cart > Checkout > Name > Email > Continue > Password (*'guest checkout should be default') > Confirm > Continue (X2) > Address > Phone > Continue > Country > City > State > Zip > Continue > Tip (\$5) > Next step > Delivery (*'what does delivery mean for a digital ticket?') > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Submit > Confirmation ✓ [2:58]	Campaign page > Scrolled to bottom first (*looking for 'how to buy' instructions) > Back up > Tickets > GA > Qty: 1 (*tried clicking spinner wrong area) > Add to Cart > Checkout Now > Name > Email > Continue > Create account (*completely unexpected) > Password > Confirm > Continue > Continue > Address (slow – used dummy info from Zoom) > Phone > Continue > Country > City > State > Zip > Continue > Tip (skipped) > Next step > Card (*retrieved dummy card from Zoom chat) > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Submit > Confirmation ✓ [4:55]
Expected: click Buy > put in card > get confirmation. Three steps maximum. Three-step expectation is the common baseline — anything beyond it is perceived as excessive friction regardless of how well executed. [00:34:35 → 00:35:30]	Expected: select ticket > quantity > guest or account checkout option > card > confirmation. Named the choice between guest and account as the standard modern pattern. Guest checkout as an expected norm — its absence is not just friction but a violation of a web convention. [00:34:45 → 00:35:40]	Expected: click 'Buy Ticket' > fill in card > receive confirmation email. Said screen confirmation felt insufficient — expected an email to follow. Email confirmation as the 'real' proof of transaction — screen confirmation is not trusted as sufficient evidence of completion. Said <i>"I wasn't sure a screen confirmation meant it had actually worked."</i> [00:34:35 → 00:35:30]

Main friction: account creation, and a timeout on the final step — no confirmation screen received. Said not knowing if the money went through is the worst possible end to a checkout. TIMEOUT RECORDED. Timeout on the final step with no confirmation is the highest-severity failure point of the study — donor uncertainty about payment completion destroys trust and prevents return. Said <i>"I don't know if my money went through. That's the worst possible end to a checkout."</i> [00:38:30 → 00:40:10]	Main friction: 'Delivery method' label for a digital ticket. Also queried why address was needed. 'Every unexpected step makes me wonder if I'm doing something wrong' — articulates the emotional experience of checkout friction precisely. Said <i>"Every unexpected step makes me wonder if I'm doing something wrong."</i> [00:38:30 → 00:40:10]	Main friction: found the Tickets section slowly (scrolled to bottom first). Account creation was the biggest barrier — almost quit at that step. Said screen confirmation felt insufficient. 'I've abandoned carts for less' — this donor is at the margin of completion. One more unexpected step would have caused dropout. Said <i>"I almost gave up at the password step. I've abandoned carts for less."</i> [00:38:20 → 00:40:00]
Campaign page > Raffle (*found 2nd attempt) > Prize > Buy Entries > Qty: 10 (*struggled with spinner — typed number instead) > Checkout > Continue (X2) > Anonymous (*missed option) > Bonus entries (*didn't read — clicked continue) > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Pay ✓ Auction > Found section > Select item > Place Bid (*wasn't sure what 'bid' meant here) > Amount > Submit ✓ [6:55]	Campaign page > Raffle > Browse prizes (*strategic selection by value) > Buy Entries > Qty: 10 > Checkout > Continue (X2) > Anonymous? (*chose anonymous — 'privacy matters') > Bonus entries (*read T&Cs before accepting) > Continue > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Pay ✓ Auction > Browse > Read descriptions (*frustrated: 'no detailed descriptions') > Select item > Place Bid (above minimum — strategic) > Submit > Confirm ✓ [4:20]	Campaign page > Raffle (*scrolled past twice — visual prominence issue) > Found with context > Prize > Buy Entries > Qty: 10 (*spinner slow) > Checkout > Continue (X2) > Anonymous (*didn't notice) > Bonus entries (*read once — confused — accepted) > Card > Expiry > CVC > Zip > Pay ✓ Auction > Found > Select first item > Place Bid (*'is this like eBay? Am I locked in?') > Amount > Submit ✓ [7:40]

Raffle found on second attempt. Bonus entries clicked without reading. Auction: wasn't sure what 'placing a bid' committed him to paying. Bid commitment ambiguity is a trust barrier — donors who don't know if a bid is a guaranteed payment will underbid or avoid bidding entirely. Said <i>"I wasn't sure if pressing bid meant I was definitely paying. That scared me a little."</i> [00:45:20 → 00:47:00]	Anonymous: chose privacy explicitly. Bonus entries: read T&Cs most thoroughly of all participants. Frustrated by lack of auction item details. T&C review before accepting bonus entries is the highest-trust behaviour of the study — this participant protects herself and wants the platform to earn her trust, not assume it. Said <i>"I want to understand what I'm agreeing to before clicking accept."</i> [00:45:30 → 00:47:10]	Scrolled past raffle section twice — visual prominence issue confirmed. Bonus entries accepted without understanding. Auction: asked aloud if a bid was a guaranteed payment commitment. 'Is this like eBay? Am I locked in if I bid?' — this is the novice-donor mental model for online auctions. The platform must answer this question proactively on the bidding interface. Said <i>"Is this like eBay? Am I locked in if I bid?"</i>
Worked: basic checkout flow understandable once inside. Didn't work: raffle hard to find, bid commitment ambiguity, no confirmation screen in Task 1 (timeout), bonus entries accepted without understanding. [00:47:05 → 00:49:00]	Worked: bonus entries standout positive — felt strategic and rewarding. Raffle checkout fast after Task 1 familiarity. Didn't work: auction item descriptions inadequate, no bid history or current leader, no time-left counter per auction item, 'Delivery method' label. [00:47:15 → 00:49:10]	Worked: visual layout navigable enough to complete both tasks. Didn't work: bid commitment ambiguity, bonus entries confusing, no first-timer auction guidance, account creation barrier, insufficient confirmation feedback. [00:47:05 → 00:49:00]
<i>"I don't know if my money went through. That's the worst possible end to a checkout."</i> — [P8, 00:39:30]	<i>"I want to understand what I'm agreeing to before I click accept."</i> — [P9, 00:46:40]	<i>"Is this like eBay? Am I locked in if I bid?"</i> — [P10, 00:46:30]
Option A (UNICEF): 'I know UNICEF — I'd give without hesitation.' Option B (RallyUp): 'Looks modern and clean. I'd explore it before I'd give.' [00:51:05 → 00:53:00]	Option A (UNICEF): 'Brand-led trust — safe, credible, familiar.' Option B (RallyUp): 'Design-led trust — the UI communicates professionalism even without a known brand. More engaging for active participation.' [00:51:15 → 00:53:10]	Option A (UNICEF): 'I recognised it immediately — very reassuring.' Option B (RallyUp): 'Clean and modern but I wasn't sure what RallyUp was at first. I'd want to see who's behind it.' [00:51:05 → 00:53:00]

Option A (UNICEF). Said 'I know the name. That's the fastest trust signal there is. I'd Google RallyUp before giving them my card.' [00:53:05 → 00:54:30]	Option B (RallyUp) for transaction completion. Said 'Option A builds trust through brand. Option B builds trust through design — and for actually clicking pay, design trust matters more.' [00:53:15 → 00:54:40]	Option A (UNICEF) by recognition. Said 'I'd feel safer typing my card number into a page with a brand I've heard of. RallyUp would need more verification signals before I'd give payment information.' [00:53:05 → 00:54:30]
<i>"I'd Google RallyUp before giving them my card." — [P8, 00:53:45]</i>	<i>"Option B builds trust through design — and for clicking 'pay', design trust matters more." — [P9, 00:53:55]</i>	<i>"RallyUp needs more verification signals before I'd give them my payment information." — [P10, 00:53:45]</i>
'A visible contact or chat option on the campaign page would have helped me when I had a question. I didn't know who to ask and almost dropped off.' [00:55:00 → 00:56:00]	'Bid notifications — email or push — when I've been outbid would keep me engaged long after the event ends. Right now I bid and then have no idea what happened.' [00:55:10 → 00:56:10]	I'd just want it explained better. Every time I felt confused I thought about leaving. A simple FAQ or a 'how this works' explainer at the top would have helped me stay.' [00:55:00 → 00:56:00]
Yes — email. Said 'I want to try it again with what I know now.' [00:56:05 → 00:56:25]	Yes — email. Interested in bid notification, real-time event, and impact reporting studies. [00:56:15 → 00:56:35]	Yes — phone preferred. Said 'Email I might miss. A phone call I can handle.' [00:56:05 → 00:56:25]
<i>"A visible contact option would have stopped me from almost dropping off." — [P8, 00:55:20]</i>	<i>"Bid notifications when I've been outbid would keep me engaged after the event ends." — [P9, 00:55:30]</i>	<i>"Every time I felt confused I thought about leaving." — [P10, 00:55:20]</i>

<i>Consistent novice across all tasks — timeout in Task 1, bid commitment confusion in Task 2, bonus entries accepted without understanding.</i> <i>His uncertainty about Task 1 completion ('I don't know if my money went through') represents the highest-stakes friction point of the study.</i> <i>Priority for checkout confirmation and completion design. [General session observation]</i>	<i>Most comprehensive mental model of all participants — named specific features for each event type.</i> <i>Marketing background produced highly actionable feedback.</i> <i>Her 'design trust vs. brand trust' framing for the mockup comparison is a strategic insight worth elevating in the final report. [General session observation]</i>	<i>New-to-digital donor identity pervasive — every confusion traced to unfamiliarity with online conventions. '</i> <i>Every time I felt confused I thought about leaving' is the most direct expression of new-donor dropout risk in the study.</i> <i>A 'how this works' explainer would have a disproportionate impact on this segment's completion rate. [General session observation]</i>
--	---	---